



Prevention of Commingling & Contamination

C 4.0

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Operator
#:

2487

Operation Name:

Randy & Whilden Hughes

Date:

11/25/2025

A. Irrigation Water

1. Do you irrigate?

☒ YES ☐ NOIf **NO**, please skip to section B (Materials Storage).

2. Please indicate your irrigation system type and water source(s) :

a) Type

- ☒ Center Pivot ☐ Drip Line
☐ Overhead ☐ Buried Drip Tape
☐ Flood ☐ Sprinklers
☐ Other (specify):

b) Source:

- ☒ On-site well ☐ Spring
☐ Municipal/County/City ☐ River/Creek
☐ Reservoir/Pond ☐ Water District/irrigation ditch (name):
☐ Catchment/cistern ☐ Other (specify):

3. Please indicate how you assess and manage potential risks for contamination of irrigation water:

- ☐ Water testing
☐ Monitoring of neighboring and/or upstream conventional activity (i.e. fertilizers, herbicides, etc.)
☐ Communication with water source (i.e. irrigation/water district, municipal/county/city, etc.)
☒ Other (specify): Any lubricants for irrigators are food grade, conventional and organic ground irrigated by separate wells, pumps, and irrigators.

4. If you obtain water from irrigation districts/public water sources, please submit documentation from irrigation district/public water source which includes information regarding management of water system (i.e. application of algicides or other materials, etc.) and any other information pertinent to the water quality and/or water quality management (i.e. water quality reports, etc.).

☐ Documentation attached ☒ N/A, do not obtain water from irrigation district/public water source

5. If you have a split operation, are any irrigation systems used and/or shared between both organic and non-organic parcels during a production season?

☐ YES ☒ NO ☐ Not Applicable; all organic operation.

If **YES**, do you chemigate or fertigate with prohibited substances on non-organic parcels using irrigation systems shared with organic parcels?

- ☐ YES. Written procedure/practices and documentation pertaining to prevention of contamination of irrigation systems shared between organic and non-organic production is attached or has previously been submitted to OCIA.
☐ NO, my operation does not chemigate or fertigate with prohibited substances on non-organic parcels.



B. Materials Storage

1. Do you store any prohibited materials on farm?

☒ YES ☐ NO

If **YES**, how do you clearly identify and separate allowed and prohibited materials?

Conventional seed and inputs are housed in a completely separate side of our building. Everything is clearly marked on pallet racking. All staff is fully educated on best practices. Liquid inputs are stored in unique containers and never used back and forth between organic and conventional. Our grain bin storage is smooth walled and cone bottom to ensure complete evacuation of grain. They are swept and air blown after use. They are also clearly marked and bin registers are kept up to date. all conveyors on farm are belted to allow for quick and complete clean out.

C. Equipment and Containers: Production, Application and Harvest

1. Do you use (own/rent/contract) any equipment (seeders, fertilizer or pesticide applicators, harvest equipment or containers) that is also used for non-organic production? **Please note "non-organic" includes harvest of buffers.**

☒ YES ☐ NO. All equipment is dedicated to organic.

If **YES**, please maintain cleaning records for equipment that is also used for non-organic production. These will be reviewed at inspection.

2. Describe your harvest practices, including buffers, and list equipment and containers used.

Organics are done first when possible. Complete clean outs occur when it is not feasible. Clean out logs are kept. 2 Case combines, 2 buggy's, 6 grain trailers. Buffer zones are harvested first to allow for a purge of the machines.

A New leader dry box spreader is used to apply some organic and conventional inputs. It has stainless walls and smooth belts allowing for complete clean out. We installed an air compressor on the unit to allow for fast and easy in the field clean outs.



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3. Do you use the service of custom applicators (pesticides, fertilizers, other), operators, or harvesters? ☒ YES ☐ NO
If **YES**, describe the service and how you monitor the prevention of contamination or commingling.

Vegetable crops are harvested by Seneca Foods equipment. They run under their own certification and provide us with clean out logs.

Conventional ground is sprayed by the DeLong Company. We have excellent communication and have made sure each applicator has up to date maps identifying organic fields. Our organic fields are marked in their internal mapping system.

Kutz Enterprises do occasional custom manure/compost spreading for us. They do not handle any prohibited substances with the equipment used on our farm.

We keep close contact with management and applicators for these organizations. By the nature of each practice, chances of contamination are very slim. However, we always make sure their certification is up to date, and promptly request any relevant paperwork or field records.

4. Does anyone else assist in your farming operation other than those listed as contacts, or listed above as custom harvesters/applicators? Examples might be extended family members, hired labor, consultants, contract growers, other land owners or renters, etc.

no

5. If any equipment or container is shared with non-organic products, describe how you prevent commingling and contamination. ☐ Not Applicable; all equipment and containers are dedicated to organic.



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All equipment or containers are blown, swept, washed, or otherwise cleaned out. Clean out logs are signed and dated. Once we are into organic ground, we try as hard as possible to stay in the organic until it is finished. We keep internal clean out tickets in every piece of equipment and those filled out and handed in when clean outs are completed.

6. Is your equipment maintained so that fuel, oil and hydraulic fluid do not leak? ☒ YES ☐ NO

7. If there is mixed or parallel production on the operation, are any conventional genetically modified (GMO) crops produced? ☒ YES ☐ NO ☐ Not Applicable

8. If GMO crops are produced, describe how you prevent commingling and contamination of organic crops from GMO crops. ☐ Not Applicable; no GMO crops produced

For the first time in many years, we chose to plant roughly 70 acres of Roundup Ready soybeans on a small group of rented fields north of town. While not an easy decision, we felt it was the right move for the operation. These acres are fairly isolated from the rest of the farm and have developed moderate to heavy ragweed pressure.

After careful consideration, we concluded that our high-management crops—like organic seed corn, vegetables, and seed-grade small grains—would benefit more from our focused time and resources. The RR beans went in early, after which that planter was switched to non-GMO crops and then thoroughly cleaned out for organic use.

Fortunately, these fields are located near an elevator that accepts RR soybeans. At harvest, one combine and one truck will be dedicated to hauling directly to the elevator. No seed, inputs, or grain from these acres are stored on the farm.

D. Transport

1. Please indicate the containers, equipment and vehicles used to transport crops/products harvested from the field, and describe destination.

We have two 1000 bu buggy's and we own 6 hopper bottom trailers and two tandems used to deliver goods to market. We have multiple markets and customers, but we typically haul to locations around Wisconsin, Minnesota, and Illinois.



2. If any vehicle is shared with non-organic products, describe how you prevent commingling and contamination.

☐ Not Applicable; all vehicles are dedicated to organic.

All Trailers are swept, washed, blown out, or cleaned otherwise to ensure there is no chance of commingling. Internal tickets are filled out completely after clean out occurs. Treated seed is never stored in the equipment used to transport organic grain. All cracks and crevasses in transport equipment are sealed to prevent conventional seed contamination. Clean outs are often inspected and approved by Whilden D. or Randy Hughes

E. Product Storage

1. Check your crop/product storage practices.

- ☐ no crop or product storage
- ☒ store own product on site (farm or production facility)
- ☐ store product in a facility that is certified organic (Please keep a current copy of the organic certificate).
- ☐ store product in a non-certified organic facility (product remains in the same package or container and is not otherwise processed)



2. Please list all on-site storage areas that you manage, or contracted facilities with stand-alone certification.

☐ Not Applicable; no crops are stored

Storage ID (should match Certification Application)	On-site or Off-site	If off-site, is the storage under your management?	Type of Storage	Size/Capacity	Organic Only (OO), Conventional (C), or Not Dedicated (ND)
North Bin	on site	Yes	Grain	3700 bu	ND
South Bin	on site	Yes	Grain	3700 bu	ND





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3. If any storage area is shared with non-organic crops/products, describe how you prevent commingling and contamination. ☐ Not Applicable; all storage is dedicated organic

Bin registers are kept up to date. Magnetic "ORGANIC" labels are stuck to the side of the bin when needed. Cone bottom completely evacuates completely evacuates bin and all conveyors are belted.



4. Please describe pest control management practices for storage areas. If any substances are used to control pests, including diatomaceous earth, please ensure they are listed in the Materials List (C11.0).

bins are swept between crops. inspected to make sure they are properly sealed. The bins are on skids so they do not make contact with the ground. Area around bins is mowed and kept clean. no other practice

F. Treated Wood

1. Is there any treated wood on the farm?

☐ YES ☒ NO

If **YES**, describe how contact between wood and soil, crops and livestock is avoided.

G. Organic Fraud Prevention Plan

1. How do you verify that inputs are allowed under the NOP?

☒ Use OMRI-Listed Products ☒ Send to OCIA for approval prior to purchase ☒ Cross-check input invoices verses container received ☐ Other (explain):



2. How do you verify that organic seeds purchased are certified to the NOP?

- ☒ Verify supplier is certified on Organic Integrity Database ☐ Maintain copy of organic certificate
☒ Cross-check seed tags against invoices upon receipt of seeds ☐ Other (explain):

3. If you have employees or use contract labor, do you train them on organic practices and regulations?

- ☒ YES ☐ NO ☐ N/A, no employees or contract labor